

New Zealand Student Cost Planner

A practical planning worksheet to estimate course costs, visa costs, arrival costs and monthly living expenses before you study in New Zealand.

Best used after you have a preferred course, expected start date and likely study city.

Tuition plan

Living budget

Arrival costs

Before you start

This planner is a preparation guide, not financial or immigration advice. Costs vary by provider, city, accommodation type, exchange rate and lifestyle. Always check your offer of place, Immigration New Zealand and your education provider before applying or paying fees.

Budget planning at a glance

Build your budget in five parts so you know what needs to be paid now, later and every month.

01

Course costs

Tuition, admin fees, materials and student services costs.

02

Visa costs

Application fee, health checks, police checks and translations.

03

Travel costs

Flights, travel insurance, airport transfer and first arrival expenses.

04

Living costs

Rent, food, transport, utilities, phone and personal spending.

05

Safety buffer

Extra savings for delays, emergencies or unexpected setup costs.

Student visa funds starting point

For tertiary, English language and other non-compulsory study, Immigration New Zealand currently says students need NZD \$20,000 for each year of living costs, or NZD \$1,667 for each month if the study is shorter than 1 year. You also need to show tuition can be paid and that you can leave New Zealand at the end of your stay.

One-off study and arrival costs

Use your actual offer, invoices and quotes where possible. Add a note if an amount is estimated.

Planner 1: one-off costs

Cost item	Estimate	Paid?	Notes
Course tuition	NZD \$	☐	From offer/invoice
Enrolment/admin fee	NZD \$	☐	Provider dependent
Student services levy or materials	NZD \$	☐	Books, tools, uniform, software
Medical and travel insurance	NZD \$	☐	Must be acceptable to provider
Student visa application fee	NZD \$	☐	Fee Paying Student Visa starts from NZD \$850
Medical exam or chest X-ray	NZD \$	☐	If required
Police certificate and translations	NZD \$	☐	If required
English test or academic documents	NZD \$	☐	IELTS/PTE/transcripts if needed
Flights to New Zealand	NZD \$	☐	Include baggage
Outward travel funds or ticket	NZD \$	☐	Ticket out or extra funds
Airport transfer and first transport	NZD \$	☐	Bus, shuttle, taxi or rideshare
First 2-4 weeks accommodation	NZD \$	☐	Temporary stay or prepaid rent
Bond/rent deposit	NZD \$	☐	Flat/homestay/hall setup
Basic setup costs	NZD \$	☐	Bedding, cookware, clothing, SIM
Laptop/phone/study equipment	NZD \$	☐	If not already owned

A. One-off costs NZD \$_____	B. Monthly budget x months NZD \$_____	C. Safety buffer NZD \$_____
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Estimated total needed before study starts: NZD \$_____

Monthly living budget

Estimate your weekly costs, convert them to monthly costs and compare the result against your available funds.

Quick conversion

Monthly estimate = weekly estimate x 4.33. For example, NZD \$250 per week is around NZD \$1,083 per month.

Planner 2: weekly to monthly budget

Category	Weekly	Convert	Monthly	Notes
Accommodation/rent	NZD \$	x 4.33	NZD \$	Flat, homestay, hall or private rental
Power/electricity	NZD \$	x 4.33	NZD \$	Usually shared in a flat
Internet/phone	NZD \$	x 4.33	NZD \$	Phone plan plus shared wifi
Groceries/food	NZD \$	x 4.33	NZD \$	Food shopping and basic meals
Transport	NZD \$	x 4.33	NZD \$	Bus/train/fuel/bike costs
Insurance/health/prescriptions	NZD \$	x 4.33	NZD \$	Ongoing health or medicine
Study supplies	NZD \$	x 4.33	NZD \$	Printing, software, books
Personal items	NZD \$	x 4.33	NZD \$	Clothing, toiletries, haircut
Eating out/entertainment	NZD \$	x 4.33	NZD \$	Social spending
Emergency savings	NZD \$	x 4.33	NZD \$	Recommended buffer
Other	NZD \$	x 4.33	NZD \$	Add your own category

Typical costs to research before you book

These are common cost categories students often miss when planning.

Research checklist

Area	What to check
Accommodation	Shared room, homestay, hall, private room, bond and first rent
Food	Groceries, packed lunches, eating out and weekend spending
Utilities	Power, heating, water if applicable and shared internet
Transport	Student concessions, distance to campus and late-night transport
Course extras	Uniform, tools, software, placements, printing and field trips
Arrival buffer	First month can be more expensive because you are setting up

Funds, proof and safety checks

A budget is more useful when your funding evidence matches your study plan clearly.

Funding evidence to prepare

- ☐ Recent bank statements showing account name, balance and transaction history.
- ☐ Clear source of funds for large deposits, savings, loans or family support.
- ☐ Scholarship, education loan or sponsor evidence if someone else is helping.
- ☐ Currency conversion notes if your funds are not in NZD.
- ☐ Tuition receipt, invoice or payment plan from the provider.
- ☐ Evidence of outward travel funds or a paid ticket out of New Zealand.

Budget risks to avoid

- ☐ Only budgeting for tuition and forgetting rent, food, travel and setup costs.
- ☐ Relying on part-time work before you have confirmed visa work conditions.
- ☐ No emergency buffer for delays, bond, equipment or medical costs.
- ☐ Using old exchange rates or assuming costs are the same in every city.
- ☐ Unclear family support with no documents explaining who owns the funds.
- ☐ Submitting financial evidence that does not match your course length.

Final total planner

Bring the numbers together before you apply or pay major fees.

Planner 3: final cost summary

Summary item	Amount
One-off study and arrival costs	NZD \$
Living budget for first 3 months	NZD \$
Living budget for full course or first year	NZD \$
Safety buffer	NZD \$
Total funds available now	NZD \$
Funding gap to solve	NZD \$

How Enrollify can help

We can help you compare suitable study options, understand likely course costs and organise your budget before you take the next step. If your situation needs personal immigration advice, we can help you understand when to speak with a licensed adviser.

Ready to plan your study budget?

Speak with Enrollify about your course goals, likely study costs and next steps.

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